

NEON Niwot Ridge litter dataset

Summary

This dataset was prepared for Environmental Data Analytics (ENV 700) at Duke University, Fall 2026

The dataset contains data from monitoring at the Niwot Ridge Long-Term Ecological Research (LTER) station, comprising trap data for litter and small woody debris 2016-2026.

Database Information

Data were collected from the National Ecological Observatory Network (NEON)'s Data Products Site (<https://data.neon.science.org/data-products/explore>). "Litter" was inputted into the Search Bar and "Litterfall and fine woody debris production and chemistry" was selected (<https://data.neonscience.org/data-products/DP1.10033.001>)

RELEASE-2026 was chosen (<https://www.neonscience.org/release-2026>), extracting data from Jan 2016 to Dec 2024. Then the site "NIWO" was selected and all "basic" data for this site were downloaded. Data were downloaded as a zip file that included a separate data folder for each month of sampling.

The following Python code is used to extract the litter and trap data CSV as well as the user guide.

```
#Import packages
import shutil
from neonutilities as nu

#Expand the zip file
nu.stack_by_table('Neon_litterfall.zip')

#Rename litter and trap files to root folder, also user guide
shutil.move('Neon_litterfall/stackedFiles/ltr_massdata.csv', 'NEON_NIWO_Litter_massdata_2016-26_raw.csv')
shutil.move('Neon_litterfall/stackedFiles/ltr_pertrap.csv', 'NEON_NIWO_Litter_trapdata_raw.csv')
shutil.move('Neon_litterfall/NEON_LTR_userGuide_vF.pdf', 'NEON_Litterfall_UserGuide.pdf')

#Remove the Neon_litterfall folder
shutil.rmtree('Neon_litterfall')
```

Data were accessed 2026-06-12.

Data Content Information

See the `NEON_Litterfall_UserGuide.pdf` metadata file for more information about column headers and codes.

Additional Information and Support

For more information, please contact the data assembler, John Fay (john.fay@duke.edu)